

Cool.org × Co-Exist Schools Challenge

Concept doc, 5 May 2026. Internal. Read time ~5 min.

Cool.org runs Australia’s largest free climate-action education platform, with a teacher reach of roughly 150,000 across approximately 6,000 schools. They host sponsor-branded competitions, the most established being the MobileMuster Schools Competition for mobile-phone recycling. We propose **Co-Exist Schools Challenge**: a branded biodiversity / habitat / wildlife-recording competition where Co-Exist is the tracking and submission platform, Cool.org distributes through their teacher network, students compete on real conservation outcomes, and finalists are awarded at term-end. Cool.org brings the distribution. We bring the delivery. A corporate biodiversity-CSR sponsor pays for the branded competition.

1. Why this works for Cool.org (the partner-fit case)

- **They need program partners that ship real, curriculum-aligned outcomes.** Cool.org’s own surface is curriculum + content. The competitions they host are operated by external partners. MobileMuster runs theirs end-to-end. We run ours end-to-end.
- **Curriculum alignment is already in our hand.** Co-Exist Schools Edition has an Australian Curriculum v9 alignment matrix already drafted (Sustainability, Geographies, Science: Biological Sciences). That is the artefact Cool.org gives teachers, in their tone and structure.
- **Zero risk to their brand.** Sponsored, opt-in, term-aligned. If pickup is light, it’s a quiet pilot. If it lands, it becomes a flagship like MobileMuster.
- **Their distribution, our delivery.** They do not have to build, host, or maintain the competition platform. We do.

2. What we’d build (Co-Exist Schools Edition)

- **Branded competition layer over Co-Exist.** Class registration, school registration, region/state leaderboards, real-time rankings.
- **Wildlife-recording mechanic.** Students log species observations from their schoolyard, local park, or excursion site. Photo + GPS + species ID. Co-Exist already has the engagement primitive.
- **Verification and weighting.** Records weighted by species rarity, by class participation rate, by repeat-visit consistency. Removes the “most kids = most points” failure mode.
- **Awards mechanic.** Term-end rankings. State winners. National winner. Awards ceremony (live or recorded), certificates, prize donated by sponsor.
- **Teacher dashboard.** Class-level reporting. Curriculum-tag mapped to AC v9. Teacher gets a printable assessment artefact at term end. This is what makes the platform sticky after the competition window.

3. Distribution math (the offer they bring)

Pickup rate	Teachers	Students reached (avg 25/class)	Likely active student users
Light (0.1%)	150	3,750	~1,500–2,000

Moderate (1%)	1,500	37,500	~10,000–15,000
Strong (3%)	4,500	112,500	~30,000–45,000

Reference point: MobileMuster Schools Competition reports tens of thousands of student participants per year via Cool.org distribution. We're positioning at the moderate end of that range as the realistic Year-1 target.

4. Revenue model (this is the important part)

We do **not** sell Co-Exist to Cool.org. Cool.org's commercial model is sponsor-funded competitions, not paid-platform integrations. The economics work because a corporate biodiversity-CSR sponsor underwrites the whole arrangement.

Party	What they pay / receive
Corporate sponsor (e.g. a bank, insurer, mining conservation arm, Suncorp Group, Bendigo Bank, IAG, Stockland, Lendlease)	Pays \$50–150k AUD for a branded sponsored competition (national reach + 6-month term + naming rights + impact report).
Cool.org	Receives a partner share for distribution and curriculum-asset hosting. Their standard sponsorship arrangement.
Ecodia	Receives the build fee + operational fee from the remaining sponsor budget. Co-Exist platform retained in Ecodia Labs (per IP-retention doctrine).
Schools, teachers, students	Free participation. Curriculum-aligned activity, photographable outcomes, sponsor prize.

This is the same shape as MobileMuster Schools Competition. The sponsor pays, the distribution platform hosts, the operator delivers, the schools participate free.

5. Who at Cool.org

- **Sarah Houbolt**, CEO. Public profile, LinkedIn-researchable. Approachable through warm-network channels.
- **Open question:** Cool.org's named partnerships lead is not yet verified. CEO is the right initial signal, but the operational counterpart is who actually scopes the partnership.

6. The mechanism: content-pull, not cold email

The wrong move is to email Sarah Houbolt with a deck attached. The right move is to **publish the concept first** as a public artefact and let the inbound find us.

1. **Publish.** Co-Exist Schools Challenge concept goes out as Quorum of One Edition 005, or a standalone LinkedIn longform from Tate. Frame: "We're looking for distribution partners for a biodiversity schools competition, Term 3 2026. Cool.org-shape, MobileMuster-template. Here's the concept."
2. **Wait for the pull.** Sarah responds, or one of her team flags it, or a warm intro arrives via someone else who reads the post.
3. **Send the one-pager.** Once the pull lands, the one-page partnership brief goes out as a follow-up, on Tate's explicit go-ahead per the no-client-contact rule.

4. **Parallel sponsor track.** While the Cool.org pull is open, identify the corporate biodiversity-CSR sponsor target list and surface them through Tate-personal-network channels. The sponsor signing-up is what converts “maybe” into “yes” with Cool.org.

7. Why this partnership now

- **Substrate is drafted.** Co-Exist Schools Edition AC v9 alignment matrix exists. Build cost is incremental, not from-scratch.
- **Term 3 2026 timing fits.** Term 3 starts mid-July 2026 in most states. Pitching now (May), securing partnership (June), launching pilot Term 3 (July–September) is a clean cadence.
- **Corporate biodiversity-CSR cycle aligns.** AASB S2 mandatory climate disclosure (Group 2 commences 1 July 2026) is pushing corporates to find credible community-impact spend categories. Schools-biodiversity programs are exactly the shape they need.
- **No incumbent owns this.** MobileMuster owns the recycling category. There is no biodiversity-equivalent at the Cool.org-distributed scale. Open territory.

8. Risks (named)

- **Cool.org may not be open to a new sponsored competition slot in Term 3.** Mitigant: position for Term 4 2026 or Term 1 2027 if Term 3 is full. Long-runway anyway.
- **Sponsor track is the actual conversion gate.** Cool.org is unlikely to commit without a confirmed sponsor. Mitigant: run sponsor track in parallel, not sequentially.
- **Pickup risk.** Light pickup at 0.1% is still a usable pilot, but a flop competition burns the brand. Mitigant: minimum-viable pilot at small scale (10–50 schools) if sponsor budget allows, scale up Year 2.

The ask of Tate

Confirm or redirect. If yes:

1. Tate or EcodiaOS publishes the content-pull artefact (Quorum of One Edition 005 or a standalone Tate-LinkedIn longform), framed as “looking for distribution partners for a biodiversity schools competition Term 3 2026”.
2. Conductor drafts the one-page partnership brief for Sarah Houbolt, ready to send the moment the pull lands.
3. Tate names two or three corporate biodiversity-CSR sponsor targets from his personal network. Conductor preps the parallel sponsor approach for those.